



No Szechuan sauce for Rick and Morty fans
After all the fiasco behind the revived sauce, the creators of Rick and Morty have distanced themselves from McDonald's. <http://dgit.in/SchzwnRM>



First look at Constantine animated
Watch the first look of the animated Constantine series revealed at New York Comic Con. <http://dgit.in/ConstntnWB>

platforms, there are quite a few good options, like Coursera (<http://dgit.in/CoursCAD>) that offer specialisations ranging from VLSI CAD to game world designing. Or you could also try options from the vast repository at Lynda (<http://dgit.in/LyndCAD>). But some of the best resources to learn about CAD come from the industry itself.

INDUSTRY INITIATIVES

Autodesk University (<http://dgit.in/AutoUniv>) is a comprehensive and easy to use repository of learning resources available online if you're interested in CAD. The platform, while imparting technical knowledge about the various tools in Autodesk's arsenal, also takes you through the know-how and importance of design principles and concepts. Mainly based on videos, the platform also provides materials in the form of presentations and transcripts of the course you're interested in taking. Another useful platform from Autodesk is the Autodesk Design Academy (<http://dgit.in/ADAcadmy>).

Another company that provides a lot of helpful resources for aspiring CAE professionals is Ansys. As one of the most well established names in the world of engineering simulation, Ansys also provides a training centre that allows you to consume courses across CAE specialisations, with flexible payment models that let you chose a pay-per-class method (<http://dgit.in/ANSYSPPC>) or even a subscription method (<http://dgit.in/ANSYSSub>). While the pay-per-class method does turn out to be expensive as compared to the subscription, it is only the case if you're going for multiple classes to begin with. The subscription, on the other hand, charges you ₹40,000 (half of that if you're a student) for a number of benefits like 24-7 on-demand access, a mix and match of modular training content to meet your unique learning needs, and interactive



Mr. Rafiq Somani, Country Manager, South Asia Pacific and Middle East at ANSYS

discussion boards with other users and ANSYS experts.

TOOLS

As it is with the specialisations, the sheer variety of tools that are available in the world of CAD and CAE is enormous. Each has its own advantage but they broadly serve the same purpose - to provide an effective way for engineers to envision their project and, with advancements like 3D printing, build it. There are a few quite popular tools that one should be on top of nonetheless.

AutoCAD - Easily one of the most well known CAD softwares today, AutoCAD provides an entire ecosystem of CAD development based on TrustedDWG technology.

Fusion 360 - Another product from Autodesk on this list, Fusion 360 is a one stop tool that can help you design, test and fabricate - all in one place. The platform is based on the cloud.

TinkerCAD - Almost certainly the best option for beginners on a budget, TinkerCAD is a full fledged CAD platform that is available for free. Suitable for CAD professionals as well as amateurs, TinkerCAD is 3D printing oriented and allows click-to-print.

Blender - What AutoCAD is to architectural engineers, project managers and graphic designers, Blender is to animators, VFX professionals, artists, 3D printed model makers, interactive 3D application and video game developers.

While that would be some of the top tools that you can use for various CAD

objectives, that is nowhere near being a comprehensive list. For the same, check-out <http://dgit.in/CADSoft>.

THE WORK

Due to the varying nature of CAD work as explored earlier in this article, the actual roles, significance and day-to-day tasks also vary in the world of professional CAD. But broadly speaking, the industry would be divided between drafters, designers and managers.

Drafters would be the basic level in terms of work. A drafter would typically be provided with requirements from another department (or client) and would have to come with a basic blueprint that satisfies the requirement. A CAD designer would be go one-step further and conceptualise the project based on know-how of the particular area and materials it deals with. A CAD designer can be seen as a bridge between the concept and the production teams.

A CAD manager would be responsible for the end-to-end process from a design point of view. The main responsibilities of a CAD manager would be to ensure proper requirement delivery to his team, satisfactory designs and a high degree of coordination between teams during the design, testing and production phase, from a design point of view.

THE FUTURE

Just like many other design oriented fields, CAE is also moving to the cloud and hence, becoming more accessible. So the best approach right now is to scour free libraries online, undertake a project and make it happen on one of the free CAD tools available. Just like any other creative field of work, the real key to success in CAD is composed of three things - practice, practice and practice.



Autodesk University provides resources for its entire portfolio